



Remote printing, laptop battery issues, unresponsive monitor

We troubleshoot all these issues and many more...

Bunch of queries

I've been a regular reader of your magazine for over six years now. I have a Lenovo X61S, which had white smoke coming out of the exhaust, and when I got it diagnosed from the laptop repair guy, he said that the motherboard's burnt.

Now, I have 3 options with me.

- Get the motherboard replaced for 10k+.
- Get a new laptop.
- Get a second hand/used laptop for the time being

I think ₹10,000 is pretty steep. And spending that on a motherboard that doesn't have a warranty, and is a used one, is surely not what I prefer.

My X61S has served me a good 5+ years, and I wouldn't think twice before getting a new one now. But, here's the thing. Windows 8 is coming later this year and most predictions foresee a new line of laptops, some with touchscreens. They are all expected to release within a year, making my new laptop buy obsolete. I don't want that, surely. Also, with Ivy Bridge based laptops releasing in the US for the same price that i5, i7 laptops are sold in India, discourages me even further to buy a new i5 or i7 laptop.

That brings me to the third option.

My hard disk, my customizations for the OS and settings throughout in every software I've installed, and my recent upgrade to a 4GB RAM, makes me want to get a 2nd hand laptop, with Core 2 Duo or later (so that it runs Win 7), and then replace the hard disk and RAM with mine, and use it for atleast the next 12 months, until Windows 8 settles in. So, where can I buy such a laptop? In my search, I've found that the Dell Latitude D630 is a good option.

Let me know what you think about each of the options.

Thanks!

Sanjay Shah

Let us go by individual options:

1. Replacing a motherboard of your laptop, which is quite old and that too at 10K+ does not make sense.
2. Regarding a new laptop, there will always be new technologies on the horizon and you will always think that waiting is good. But you need to finalise on your basic needs. Will you be really using the touchscreen on your laptop? And considering it is a new design, new OS, new processor, are you willing to spend that much? If the answers to the questions are yes, then it will make sense to wait.
3. For the second hand laptop, if you are getting one under ₹20,000, and you want to wait for the Ivy bridge laptops, then go for it. No point spending more than ₹20,000 for a second hand laptop, if it is just going to be a stop-gap arrangement.

Free remote printing

I request you to suggest the best free software for remote printing. My office computer is connected to a local printer and the same is on broadband. I want to be able to send print jobs to this computer from anywhere as long as I am on the internet. I found PrintShare service, which fits my requirement best, but is a paid service after 20 pages. The difficult part was to find something free. Well I leave the difficult part on you. Both my systems are on Win XP SP2. Thanks in advance.

Vikash Singh



Google Cloud printing offers you remote printing facility

Looks like Google Cloud Print is the right tool for you. All you need is a Google account and you can set cloud printing from your Chrome browser. Go to Settings>Under The Hood>Google Cloud Print and enable the printer. This works with mobile devices such as smartphones and tablets as well. So long as the printer in your office is on, you can send a print job from anywhere on the planet provided you're logged into your Google account.

Can't find PCIe slot

My configuration is Intel Core 2 Duo E7500 @ 2.9 GHz, 3 GB DDR 2 RAM, Samsung HA250JC hard drive, Motherboard P5KPL-AM IN. I want to install a graphics card on it but i don't know that if my motherboard has PCIe x16 slot on it.

Please suggest a good graphics card to improve the graphics-related performance of my system. My friend suggested me to upgrade motherboard having any of the following chipsets: G35; G43; G45; Q45 and B43 to improve graphics.

Is it better to upgrade motherboard or buy a graphics card?

Please help.

My PC graphics status at present is :

- Display adapter type Intel(R) G33/G31 Express Chipset Family
- Total available graphics memory 256 MB
- Primary monitor resolution 1920x1080
- DirectX version DirectX 9.0

Akshay Chaudhary

All the ASUS P5KPL-AM motherboards have a PCIe x16 slot. It will be coloured in blue. If you are not facing any issues with your system and just want better graphics, then there is no need to upgrade the motherboard.